

2. DON'T QUIT

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"Don't Quit" is an inspirational poem often attributed to Edgar A. Guest, though its authorship is sometimes disputed. The poem encourages perseverance and resilience in the face of adversity. Through simple and straightforward language, it conveys the message that despite the challenges and setbacks one may encounter in life, it's important to keep going and never give up.



When things go wrong, as they sometimes will,
when the road you're trudging seems all uphill,
when the funds are low and the debts are high,
and you want to smile but you have to sigh,
when care is pressing you down a bit
Rest if you must, but don't you quit.

Life is queer with its twists and turns.
As everyone of us sometimes learns.
And many a fellow turns about when he might
have won had he stuck it out.
Don't give up though the pace seems slow
You may succeed with another blow.

Often the goal is nearer than
It seems to a faint and faltering man;
Often the struggler has given up
When he might have captured the victor's cup;
And he learned too late when the night came down,
how close he was to the golden crown.

Success is failure turned inside out
The silver tint of the clouds of doubt,
and when you never can tell how close you are,
it may be near when it seems afar;
so stick to the fight when you're hardest hit
It's when things seem worst, you must not quit.

EXERCISE 1- POST READING

1. What is the poet's message in the first stanza?

The introductory verse of Edgar A. Guest's poem 'Don't quit' advises an individual to show perseverance no matter what happens in life. He should continue his struggles until he overcomes his obstacles. He should smile even when circumstance are such that he doesn't want to smile. If the journey of life is difficult, he can take a break to heal but he should never surrender.

2. Which lines of the poem do like the most and why?

A1. The poem's lines 'Success is failure turned inside out' is one of my favorites. These lines suggest that every failure has lessons that must be understood in order to be successful in subsequent attempts. Failure does not necessarily imply that one's endeavor was entirely unsuccessful. One might make some minor errors that prevent him from succeeding but one must remember that success is the antithesis of failure. **OR**

A2. The poem's line 'Life is queer with its twists and turns' is one of my favorites. I like this line because it depicts the true picture of a life that goes through a lot of ups and downs. Our life never remains the same and is filled with happiness and sorrows at the same time.

3. Write the CENTRAL IDEA of the poem.

Edgar A. guest in the poem 'Don't Quit' highlights the significance of perseverance, tenacity, determination and will-power to not to give up – especially when the things are going wrong, and when one is seemingly swimming against the tide. This poem reminds us that there are seeds of success in every failure, and that's why we mustn't quit. The poem rekindles the self-confidence, which essentially enables us to believe in our abilities to achieve the goals that may appear beyond any rationale, common reasoning and normal logic. This self-confidence is particularly important in life, because it empowers us to bring our dreams to reality without getting disheartened from the failures and challenges that might come in the way.

4. Find similes, metaphors and alliterations in the poem.

Similes: When things go wrong as they sometimes will.

Metaphor: Success is failure turned inside out.

When he might have captured the victor's cup.

How close he was to the golden crown

Alliterations: Life is queer with its twists and turns

When he might have won had he stuck it out

It seems to a faint and faltering man.

5. Discuss how the poem helps the reader to be optimistic in every situation?

The poem helps the reader to be optimistic in every situation of life. Repeatedly, it asks them to continue their struggles no matter how many challenges and obstacles come in the way. The poem considers the failures as the stepping stones of success and thus teaches the lesson of positivity in life.

6. What effect does the poem create on the reader?

The poem creates a positive and encouraging impact on the reader that helps him to remain optimistic in every situation of life. It obligates the reader to remain steadfast and perseverant while facing the obstacles of life.

7. What is the message of the poem?

The message of the poem is that one should remain determined, resolute, optimistic, and persistent in life. One should act upon his will power and should not give up when faced with unfavorable circumstances. Instead, one should learn from his mistakes and keep struggling to achieve his goals.

8. Why does the poet term life 'queer with twists and turns'?

The poet terms life 'queer with twists and turns' in order to tell us that life is full of ups and downs. Our life is comparable to a journey on road with numerous blind turns and twists leading to unpredictability. So, we should not be worried and dejected while facing the challenges of life.

9. What is the benefit of not quitting as suggested in the poem?

The benefit of not quitting as suggested in the poem is utmost success. If one does not quit in face of the terrible defeat and remains strong and determined, he will definitely be victorious and reach his destination.

POETIC DEVICES

1. Antithesis: When the funds are low and debts are high

2. Anaphora:

When the things go wrong as they sometimes will

When the road you're trudging seems uphill

When the funds are low and the debts are high

3. Similes: When things go wrong as they sometimes will.

4. Metaphor: Success is failure turned inside out.

When he might have captured the victor's cup.

How close he was to the golden crown

5. Alliterations: Life is queer with its twists and turns

When he might have won had he stuck it out

It seems to a faint and faltering man.

6. Personification: The silver tint of the clods of doubt